

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ Q 9 8 2
 ♦ 10 8 7 6 2
 ♣ 5

♠ K 4
 ♥ K 10 3
 ♦ K 9 5
 ♣ A 10 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10 8 7
 ♥ 6 5 4
 ♦ Q J 3
 ♣ K 4

♠ 9 3 2
 ♥ A J 7
 ♦ A 4
 ♣ Q J 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	1 ♠	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	5 ♣

All Pass

5 ♣ by North
 the ♠9, ruffing in your hand.

South's cue-bid shows a limit raise or better (11 points) in ♣s. North is to play 5 ♣. East leads the ♠Q, West takes the ♠A and returns the ♠6 to your ♠K.

You have lost one trick already and have a possible loser in trumps and another possible loser in ♥s. Both losers can be avoided with successful finesses. The problem with the ♣ finesse is that East made an overcall so he is more likely to hold the ♣K. If you don't try the ♣ finesse you may be able to throw a defender in with the ♣K at a time when he will have to help you with his next play.

After winning the ♠K immediately play the ♣A.

It would have been nice to see the ♣K fall, but it didn't. So play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦A and play

Eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦K, then ruffing your last ♦ in dummy.

You have done all the eliminating, time to throw in somebody. Play a ♣.

Whichever defender had the ♣K is now on lead, but wishes he wasn't. If he plays a ♥ you get a free finesse. If he plays anything else you get a ruff-sluff.

If you had finessed for the ♣K East would have won the trick and been able to make a safe exit, probably with his other ♣.

You would then have been forced to rely on the ♥ finesse, and with East being the defender who showed some strength, you would likely have finessed through him.

About the only way the elimination/throw-in could fail is if the ♣s split 3-0. Then, if you play Ace and another the defender who wins would use his third ♣ as a safe exit.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 6 2
 ♥ A 10 9 6
 ♦ A K
 ♣ 7 6 3

♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥	Pass	5♣	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East
 ♣10 if North plays low.

[showcards N:HA,H6,C7,C6 S:HK,HQ,CA,CQ]

South will probably win this trick. If he wins with the ♣K then your hand is good. If he wins with the ♣J then he is end-played, forced to either lead a ♣ into your ♣ A Q or to give you a ruff-sluff.

You probably noticed that you could have finessed your ♣Q on the first ♣ play and pulled off the end-play just as effectively. But there is an advantage to making the first finesse with the ♣10.

If North just happens to hold both the ♣K and ♣J you will make all thirteen tricks if your first finesse is with the ♣10!

Your 3♥ bid is a slam suggestion. After you show the ♣A partner wastes no time in bidding it.

East is to play 6♥. South leads the ♠K.

This is a good slam. You have only two possible ♣ losers, and by taking two ♣ finesses you have an excellent chance of success. But by using an elimination play you will have a sure thing.

Win the ♠A and ruff a ♠ with a ♥ honor.

Play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9 and ruff another ♠. Both defenders followed to the trump play.

Play another ♥ to dummy's ♥10 and ruff the last ♠.

Play the ♦A and ♦K.

Conveniently in dummy, you play a ♣ and insert the

Board 5

South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 2
♥ K 9 7 2
♦ K 7 5 3
♣ 10 3

♠ J 10 7
♥ 8 6 5
♦ A 6 2
♣ A Q 8 4

♠ 8 5 4 3
♥ J 4 3
♦ J 10 9
♣ 9 6 2

N
W E
S

♠ A 9 6
♥ A Q 10
♦ Q 8 4
♣ K J 7 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			